ABOUT THIS PIECE

Sample IEP: autism spectrum disorder

Katherine Conklin

WHAT IT IS

A sample Individualized Education Program for a 5th-grade student with high-functioning autism. Name and personal details removed.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The present levels of performance, the goals, and the accommodations.

Individualized Education Program: Autism Spectrum Disorder

Sample IEP · Grade 5 · Student name removed · Katherine Conklin

Grade: 5th

Disability Classification: Autism Spectrum Disorder (High-Functioning)

Present Levels of Performance

Academic Performance

The student is a bright and capable student who demonstrates strong skills in areas of interest, particularly in mathematics and science. He has difficulty with reading comprehension, particularly understanding figurative language, inferencing, and summarizing. Writing is challenging, especially organizing ideas and responding to open-ended questions.

Social/Emotional Performance

The student has difficulty with peer interactions, understanding social cues, and initiating conversations. He may become overwhelmed in group settings and need structured opportunities for social engagement. He benefits from explicit instruction in social skills and support in self-regulation.

Behavioral Performance

The student follows classroom routines well but struggles with unexpected changes and transitions. He may experience anxiety in unstructured settings and require clear expectations and visual supports. He benefits from scheduled breaks and sensory strategies.

Communication

While the student has age-appropriate verbal skills, he struggles with pragmatic language, including turn-taking, topic maintenance, and recognizing nonverbal cues. He may require visual supports and role-play exercises to practice conversational skills.

Annual Goals

Academic Goals

1. Given a grade-level text, the student will use graphic organizers to summarize the main idea and key details with 80% accuracy in 4 out of 5 trials.

2. With teacher support, the student will write a multi-paragraph essay that includes a clear introduction, supporting details, and a conclusion in 4 out of 5 assignments.

Social/Emotional Goals

1. The student will engage in structured peer interactions (e.g., cooperative learning, group projects) by initiating and responding appropriately in 3 out of 5 opportunities.

2. Using a self-regulation tool (e.g., visual schedule, break card), the student will manage transitions and unexpected changes with minimal adult support in 4 out of 5 instances.

Behavioral Goals

1. The student will use a coping strategy (e.g., deep breathing, fidget tool) to manage frustration or anxiety in 4 out of 5 instances.

2. Given social stories and role-playing, the student will demonstrate appropriate responses to social situations (e.g., personal space, sharing, turn-taking) in 4 out of 5 trials.

Communication Goals

1. The student will use visual supports or social scripts to maintain a conversation for at least 4 turns in 3 out of 5 opportunities.

2. The student will recognize and respond to nonverbal social cues (e.g., facial expressions, tone of voice) with 80% accuracy in structured settings.

Accommodations & Modifications

- Preferential seating in a low-distraction area.
- Visual schedules and task organizers.
- Extended time for assignments and tests.
- Access to sensory breaks and quiet areas.
- Social stories and role-play activities for social skills.
- Structured peer interactions with teacher facilitation.
- Clear, concise instructions with visual supports.
- Opportunities for movement breaks.

Related Services

- Speech-Language Therapy: 2x/week for 30 minutes (focus on pragmatic language skills).
- Occupational Therapy: 1x/week for 30 minutes (focus on fine motor and sensory needs).
- Social Skills Group: 1x/week for 30 minutes (structured practice in peer interactions).

Placement & Least Restrictive Environment (LRE)

The student will participate in the general education classroom with the following supports:

- Co-teaching or push-in support as needed.
- Small group instruction for reading and writing.
- Pull-out services for social skills and therapy.

Transition Plan

As the student prepares for middle school, he will receive targeted support in:

- Organizational skills and executive functioning strategies.
- Increased self-advocacy and independence.

- Exposure to middle school routines and expectations through transition meetings and visits.

Parent & Student Participation

The student and their family will be involved in setting goals, reviewing progress, and attending meetings to ensure continued success and appropriate support.